

Chapter 16 – Glossary of Terms

16.1 Introduction

This glossary explains common terms used by the **Inland Revenue Department (IRD)** in relation to taxpayer registration, e-Services, and tax administration. The definitions are based on the official IRD guides and are intended to help users understand terminology used throughout this knowledge base.

A

Acknowledgement

A confirmation generated by the IRD after an online application or request has been successfully submitted. It serves as proof that the request has been received for processing.

Authorized Representative

A person who is permitted to act on behalf of a taxpayer. A valid letter of authority may be required depending on the service requested.

B

BOI

Board of Investment of Sri Lanka. Certain businesses registered with the BOI may be required to provide BOI-related information during taxpayer registration.

C

Corporate Taxpayer

A registered company or organization that manages its tax obligations through the IRD e-

Services Portal.

CAPTCHA

A security verification displayed during login to confirm that the user is a real person before access is granted to the IRD e-Services Portal.

D

Declaration

The final confirmation completed before submitting an online application, where the applicant confirms that the information provided is true and complete.

E

e-Services Portal

The Inland Revenue Department's online platform that allows taxpayers to register, update information, manage tax registrations, and access other electronic tax services.

I

Inland Revenue Department (IRD)

The government authority responsible for administering taxes in Sri Lanka, including taxpayer registration, tax collection, and operation of the e-Services Portal.

N

National Identity Card (NIC)

The primary identification document used by Sri Lankan citizens during taxpayer registration and other IRD services.

P

Personal Identification Number (PIN)

A confidential security code issued by the IRD that allows registered taxpayers to log in to the IRD e-Services Portal.

Partnership

A business owned by two or more persons that may register with the IRD and obtain a TIN.

R

Registered Company

A company incorporated under the applicable laws of Sri Lanka and registered with the Registrar of Companies. Such companies may apply for a TIN and access IRD e-Services.

ROC

Registrar of Companies. The government authority responsible for company registration. Companies may be required to submit ROC-issued documents during TIN registration.

S

Sole Proprietorship

A business owned and operated by one individual. The owner registers as an individual taxpayer and may include business details during TIN registration.

Staff Identification Number (SSID)

A unique number issued by the IRD to authorized employees of companies or registered tax agents, allowing them to access the IRD e-Services Portal on behalf of their organization.

Supporting Documents

Documents submitted with an application to verify the applicant's identity, address, business registration, or other required information.

T

Tax Agent

A person or organization registered with the IRD and authorized by a taxpayer to perform specified tax-related activities on the taxpayer's behalf.

Tax Registration

The process of registering a taxpayer for one or more tax types administered by the IRD.

Tax Type

A category of tax administered by the IRD, such as Income Tax, Value Added Tax (VAT), or Withholding Tax (WHT). Taxpayers register only for the tax types that apply to them.

Taxpayer

An individual or organization that is registered with the IRD and identified by a Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN).

Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN)

A unique identification number issued by the Inland Revenue Department to identify taxpayers and administer tax-related services.

Taxpayer Services Unit (TPSU)

The IRD unit responsible for assisting taxpayers with registration, PIN requests, taxpayer profile updates, tax type registration, and other taxpayer services.

V

Value Added Tax (VAT)

A tax type administered by the IRD that applies to eligible businesses involved in the supply of taxable goods and services, subject to the applicable provisions of tax law.

W

Withholding Tax (WHT)

A tax type under which tax is withheld at the source in accordance with the applicable provisions of Sri Lankan tax law.

Key Points

- Understanding IRD terminology helps taxpayers complete registrations and use e-Services correctly.
- The glossary serves as a quick reference for commonly used terms throughout this knowledge base.
- Definitions are based on the official IRD guidance and should be read together with the relevant chapters for detailed procedures.